



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Coram Deo Academy  
School Website: <https://coramdeo-in.com/>

December 21, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Coram Deo Academy (CDA) presents a strongly classical Christian education model, with public materials clearly framing the school as Christ-centered, classical, formation-minded, and committed to the Great Conversation. The school describes itself as a Classical Christian school that forms students through memorization, narration, and habituated virtue within a Trivium framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric), integrates Great Books and Latin, and uses Socratic discussion and rhetoric in upper grades. It emphasizes covenant-parent partnership, a Portrait of the Graduate, and real-world apprenticeships, all of which align closely with classical ideals of truth, goodness, and beauty in a Christian formation context. The public materials consistently reference virtues like wisdom, virtue, character, discernment, and other facets of moral formation, with explicit Christ-centered theology and worship as integral to the educational experience. The site also highlights faculty engagement as part of a "living curriculum" and frames the parent-school relationship as collaborative and mission-driven rather than transactional. Overall, CDA demonstrates a robust CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories of the classical rubric.

Evidence is drawn from CDA's site content, including mission statements, curricular descriptions, pedagogy, and portraits of graduate outcomes (e.g., Contagious Christian, Compelling Communicator, Critical & Creative Thinker, Lifelong Learner, Legacy Leader). See examples of mission and curriculum language, Great Books emphasis, Trivium structure, and covenant partnership with families. The school's materials consistently tie education to a Christian worldview, classical pedagogy, and a public articulation of formation over mere information. Relevant citations include CDA's About/mission language, curriculum descriptions (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; Great Books), the emphasis on Socratic discourse and memorization, and the Portrait of the Graduate.

Executive summary category-by-category snapshot indicates CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories. The school's religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit, its purpose and goals emphasize character and wisdom over mere vocational training, its curriculum foregrounds the liberal arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, history studied through a Christian lens), its pedagogy includes contemplative elements alongside Socratic discussion and rhetoric, its faculty are portrayed as mentors within a living-curriculum model, and its parent/community framework positions families as partners in a shared educational mission. The evidence supports a CLASSICAL classification overall.

Notes on methodology and data sources: - Category-by-category keyword analysis is grounded in the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document, complemented by explicit CDA site language. The Positive Keyword indicators emphasize wisdom, virtue, theology, wonder, Great Books, the Trivium, reverence for truth, and formation over mere information; Negative keywords emphasize secular, nonsectarian, interfaith, and similar secular approaches. CDA's site repeatedly uses terms aligned with the Positive Keyword indicators (Christ-centered, Great Books, Latin, memorization, narration, Socratic discussion, Portrait of the Graduate, Covenant Partnership, worship/discipleship). Where negative keywords appear in the classical framework, they are not reflected in CDA's public materials. - Primary CDA site content was gathered from the school's public pages describing mission, curriculum, pedagogy, community, and leadership; key passages include statements of faith, classical Christian education, the Trivium, Great Books, Latin, and the Great Conversation, as well as the Family/Partnering

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model and the Portrait of the Graduate.

## **Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot**

### **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - CDA presents a Christ-centered, biblical formation framework, noting that the school exists to train children biblically with “academic instruction that is distinctly and consistently Christ-centered and classical.” The statement foregrounds theology and Christian formation as foundational to the education. - Christian Discipleship materials articulate that the fear of the Lord governs wisdom, and that Bible reading and prayer are integrated with learning rather than segregated from secular subjects. This demonstrates a theologically integrated, liturgical/communal practice orientation. - The school’s discourse about “coram Deo” (in the presence of God) and identity as a Christian classical school ties metaphysical and theological foundations directly to curriculum and culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, theology, Gospel, fear of the Lord, Great Books, Great Conversation, memory/recitation within a devotional-cultural frame, liturgical/communal orientation (worship, prayer), covenant partnership with families, and a shared Gospel-centered formation (Portrait of the Graduate). These terms align with the Positive Keyword indicators for religious/metaphysical foundations (e.g., truth, virtue, worship, the sovereign role of theology in education, and a sacred orientation to learning). - Negative keywords present: None materially evident in public language (no explicit secular/neutral/anti-theology lexicon appears in CDA’s public materials).

Why this rating - The school’s public materials explicitly embed theology, communal worship, and a theological frame for all study (e.g., “Christ-centered,” “fear of the Lord,” “Great Books in light of the Bible,” “coram Deo”), which squarely aligns with the Classical model’s emphasis on transcendental moral realism and the integration of theology with curriculum. The presence of liturgical/community practices and a theology-grounded program supports a CLASSICAL classification here.

CDA aligns strongly with religious/metaphysical foundations, supported by explicit language and program structures that fuse theology, virtue, and classical education. CLASSICAL.

Citations: mission/orientation language and theological integration in About Us and Christian Discipleship pages.

### **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - CDA’s stated aim centers on formation and character: “education that is distinctly and consistently Christ-centered and classical,” with a focus on forming virtue and wisdom rather than mere job preparation. The Portrait of the Graduate emphasizes emerging virtues and capacities (Contagious Christian, Compelling Communicator, Critical & Creative Thinker, Lifelong Learner, Legacy Leader).

- The school asserts education as formation, not information, through the Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), memorization, narration, and good habits; learning is oriented toward timeless truths and human excellence in the context of a Christian worldview. - Real-world purpose statements emphasize preparation for eternity and transformation of character, not solely vocational outcomes. The Covenant/Partnership framework reinforces formation through values, Habits of the Heart, and gospel-centered aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, character, integrity, moral formation, love of learning, habits of the heart, eternal aims, discernment, self-governance, leadership, and the Portrait of the Graduate. These map to the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 2 (Formation and moral/character development; transcendental aims like truth/goodness/beauty). - Negative keywords present: Virtually none (the site does not signal a vocational-first goal or purely informational utility; it emphasizes formation and virtue rather than job-prep).

Why this rating - CDA clearly positions education as formation and character development anchored in truth and virtue, not merely information or job preparation. The explicit reference to virtues and the graduate portrait demonstrates alignment with CLASSICAL aims for wisdom and human excellence. CLASSICAL.

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Citations: mission statements, Portrait of the Graduate, and formation-focused curriculum language.

### **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly described as Trivium-based: grammar, logic, rhetoric; the K-12 curriculum emphasizes a classical structure with Latin and Great Books. The Lower/Upper School materials describe the three-stage curriculum with grammar (K–4), logic (5–8), and rhetoric (9–12). Great Books, Latin, logic, and rhetoric are central components. - History is studied chronologically and within a Christian frame; the school emphasizes reading Great Books and engaging with classic ideas within a Christian viewpoint, not “social studies” as a separate modern category. Curriculum materials also show K-2/K-12 curriculum resources and reading/literature lists. - The program highlights memorization, narration, participating in a “Great Conversation,” and a focus on timeless truths; it also references apprenticeships and real-world application via Guilds/Senior Thesis at the upper levels.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, history (timelines, Christian framing), memorization, narration, contemplation/wonder, and the Great Conversation. These map directly to the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 3 (liberal arts core; history integrated; Great Books; Latin; cultivation of wonder). - Negative keywords present: The site uses a strongly favorable frame for classic subjects; there is little to no public-language signaling of social studies-centric or secular approaches; no explicit negative terms appear (e.g., “not” or “anti-Great Books” language is absent).

Why this rating - CDA’s public materials strongly emphasize the classical curriculum—grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, chronological/history study, and formation through memorization and narration. This is a textbook CLASSICAL alignment.

Citations: descriptions of the Trivium and Great Books/Latin; K-12 Curriculum materials; and the emphasis on history studied chronologically.

### **Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Pedagogy includes contemplative/restful elements and non-rigorous moments, balanced with rigorous inquiry. The Lower School materials note that the grammar stage uses memorization, singing, and rhymes to deepen memory and delight; this reflects a contemplative, memory-based pedagogy. - In the upper grades, the school emphasizes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, including opportunities to give speeches and develop rhetorical skills. The public materials also mention the Great Conversation and a table-like Socratic discussion environment. - The school explicitly describes the grammar/logic/rhetoric progression and the use of memorization, narration, and “habits” in education, indicating a pedagogy designed to form memory, reason, and eloquence. - There is a public emphasis on a living curriculum, mentorship, and “House”/community-focused schooling that supports pedagogy through teacher-student partnerships and collaborative learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplation, memorization, singing/chanting in early grades, grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, Great Books, Socratic/dialogue/seminars, rhetoric training, public speaking, memory-rich pedagogy, and a table-style discussion. These align with the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 4 (Socratic seminars, memory-based learning, rhetoric, and contemplative elements). - Negative keywords present: The materials do not emphasize project-based or purely experiential learning as a primary mode; the emphasis is on classic methods rather than modern “project-based” formats. If anything, the presence of contemplative and memory-based methods counters heavy project-based norms, aligning with Classical expectations.

Why this rating - The pedagogy shows a deliberate mix of contemplative/recitation-based lower grades and Socratic/seminar/rhetoric-based upper grades, consistent with a classical approach (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric). CLASSICAL.

Citations: Lower School grammar/memorization/singing language; upper-school Socratic discussions and rhetoric emphasis; “Great Conversation” framing.

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### **Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The public materials describe faculty as mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; the school emphasizes a living curriculum and teachers as a core of the community; job postings and staff pages discuss faculty leadership roles (Dean of Lower/Upper School) and a collaborative, teacher-centered culture. - Language around partnership with families, mentor-like relationships, and a culture of collaboration mirrors a classical model where faculty serve as models of virtue and intellectual leadership, not just instructors. The "Portrait of a Graduate" includes attributes that reflect faculty role-modeling of character and intellect. - There are explicit roles (e.g., Deans) and a "living curriculum" frame that positions faculty as integral to the school's mission and community culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors, living curriculum, core of the school, faculty as partners with families, teacher leadership, mentorship, and a culture of collaboration. These map to the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 5 (virtue modeling, teachers as core of the school, living curriculum, collegiality). - Negative keywords present: None of the Negative Keywords that signal secular or anti-teacher roles appear in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school frames faculty as living examples of virtuous, skilled educators who form the core of the school and partner closely with families, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations of a dedicated, virtuous, and highly capable faculty. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Covenant Partnership page and About/Faculty references showing living-curriculum/mentor language and structured leadership roles.

### **Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - CDA emphasizes covenant-partnership with parents, parent involvement, and shared governance in the educational mission. The Covenant Partnership materials articulate "three complementary institutions" (family, church, state) and a team-sport approach to education with families engaged in House events, volunteering, and shared progress. - The school highlights parent engagement as part of the core community, with information about Parent Partnership, open tours, and accessible information to educate parents about classical education. The Tuition/Financial Aid materials show a focus on partnership and shared investment. - The school describes a culture where families worship, learn, and engage together; there is explicit emphasis on parents being "co-teachers" and the community being nurtured through a shared educational vision.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers with the school, family involvement, House program, parent-led engagement opportunities, parent visits/participation, and Community-oriented language. These align with Positive Keyword indicators for Element 6 (active parental involvement, shared learning, and community education). - Negative keywords present: None evident in public content.

Why this rating - The school's public content emphasizes robust parental involvement and a collaborative community culture, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for parent partnership and community immersion in classical education. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Covenant Partnership and parent-part involvement language; Tuition/Financial Aid pages indicating family involvement.

## **Overall Assessment**

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

Rationale: CDA's public materials consistently demonstrate a classical Christian education model across all six categories. The curriculum is explicitly Trivium-based with Great Books and Latin; pedagogy includes memorization, narration, and Socratic discourse; formation through virtue and character is foregrounded; the faculty are depicted as mentors within a living curriculum; and parents/community are treated as essential partners in a covenantal educational project. The presence of liturgical/theological foundations, a Portrait

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of the Graduate, and covenant-parent partnership solidifies the school's alignment with classical education principles rather than merely "somewhat classical" or "not classical."

Citations across categories reflect the school's own materials: - Mission and Christ-centered/classical framing: - Curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin): - Pedagogy (Socratic discussion; memorization; singing; narrations): - Faculty as living curriculum and core to school culture: - Parents/Community partnership:

### **What Would Move the Needle**

- Not applicable given CLASSICAL across all six categories. No major needle-moving changes are required.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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